

Couponing could be a book in itself (there's *that* much to talk about!), but the main things to remember are:

- Make coupons last, not first. Figure out what you need to buy, then print and clip coupons based on items you know you'll use. I list my favorite printable coupon sites at

CreativeSavingsBlog.com/Coupons

- Stack store coupons and manufacturer coupons with store sales for the biggest savings. Many stores will even accept competitors' coupons!
- Be organized. Make a grocery list based on your meal plan and store sales flyers, then write down any coupons you have next to each item. This saves time because you know exactly what coupons you have for what.
- Keep an accordion file (or binder) for your coupons and make sure they are always updated and accessible.

Another thing you can do is track store sales and stock up when prices are ultra low. Bonus if you can use a coupon too! Most items go on sale every six to eight weeks, so buy enough to last until the next sales cycle. It might sound counterintuitive to spend more upfront, but you'll save more in the long run.

READER TIP:

I am lazy when it comes to clipping coupons from the paper, but I love Target! I use TotallyTarget.com to help me save the most. I use Cartwheel on my phone and print Target coupons before I go and try to match things up. I also use smartphone apps like Ibotta, Checkout51, Jingit, and Snap by Groupon to get \$20 back a month. I also just started using Walmart's Savings Catcher and I've made back \$3 in two trips. Not a lot, but it's adding up fast!

—Krystal, SunnySweetDays.com